

Day 2 — The Two Halves

Module: Moon Phases & Tithi (Primary) · **Time:** 30 min

Goal

Children learn that the month has two halves — one where the Moon grows, one where it shrinks — and that *amāvasyā* and *pūrṇimā* are the special anchor nights.

Materials

- The torch and ball from Day 1
- A long strip of paper or a chalk line on the floor
- Drawing paper + crayons

The flow

Settle + recall (4 min)

Sit on the mat. Teacher: “*Did anyone see the Moon last night?*” Take 3–4 answers. “*Did you draw it in your diary?*” Show one or two diary drawings.

Chant once together: “*am - mah - vahs - yah! poor - ni - mah!*”

Story (6 min)

The Moon takes a journey.

The Moon goes around the Earth — but it takes a long time. About 30 days.

Halfway through the journey, the Moon is on the OPPOSITE side from the Sun. That’s when we see the WHOLE bright side. That’s *pūrṇimā*.

At the start of the journey — and again at the end — the Moon is on the SAME side as the Sun. We can’t see the bright side at all. That’s *amāvasyā*.

So between *amāvasyā* and *pūrṇimā* — the FIRST half of the journey — the Moon gets bigger and bigger every night. That’s the **growing half**.

Between *pūrṇimā* and *amāvasyā* — the SECOND half of the journey — the Moon gets smaller and smaller. That’s the **shrinking half**.

Demo + walk (10 min)

Draw a long line on the floor (or on the board). At the left end write *amāvasyā* and draw a dark circle. At the right end write *pūrṇimā* and draw a bright full circle.

In the middle, draw 5 stages between them — a thin sliver, a half-moon, a 3/4 moon, etc.

Now do the same for the second half — *pūrṇimā* shrinks back through 3/4, half, sliver, to *amāvasyā*.

Have 5 children walk along the line, holding a paper Moon shape at each station. The rest of the class chants “GROWING” while they walk left-to-right and “SHRINKING” while they walk right-to-left.

Drawing (7 min)

Each child draws TWO Moons on paper: 1. A *pūrṇimā* — a full bright circle. Label it “pūrṇimā.” 2. An *amāvasyā* — an empty circle (just the outline, dark inside, or a black filled circle with a tiny sliver). Label it “amāvasyā.”

Wrap-up (3 min)

- Hold up 2–3 drawings.
- Chant once more: “*am - mah - vāḥ - yah! poor - ni - mah!*”
- **Homework:** Look at the Moon tonight. Is the Moon growing or shrinking? (Ask a grown-up if you don’t know.)

Homework

- Continue the Moon Diary. Add “**growing**” or “**shrinking**” next to tonight’s sketch.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Draw all the Moon shapes on the line — not just *pūrṇimā* and *amāvasyā*.
- **Tier down:** Just draw *pūrṇimā* today. *Amāvasyā* tomorrow.

Teacher’s quick notes

- Some children will say “the Moon is hiding” on *amāvasyā*. That’s a lovely phrasing — agree, then add: “and the Sun’s bright light is making it hard for us to see anyway.”
- Watch for the misconception “the Earth’s shadow makes the new moon.” It doesn’t (that’s eclipses). Today we don’t unpack that — just say “no, it’s because we can’t see the bright side.”
- The words “growing” and “shrinking” are easier than *śukla pakṣa* / *kṛṣṇa pakṣa*. Stick with English at Primary.